

TEACH

UNIVERSAL

FOR ALL SIX PROFILES

The Tertiary Triage Decision Tree

A repeatable decision path for any draining task: scaffold it, timebox it, trade it, or automate it. **White-knuckling stops being the default strategy.**

THE DRAIN

Without a method, tertiary work gets handled the same way by everyone: endure it, procrastinate it, or silently resent it. All three cost more than the work itself, and none of them are strategies. The missing piece is a decision, made once, about how each recurring drain will be handled.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The tree routes every recurring tertiary task down one of four paths based on two questions: is it structurable, and does it energize someone else? Each path leads to a specific tool in this library. Ten minutes of triage converts a standing drain into a managed one, with a named method attached.

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **List your recurring drains.** The Energy Budget tally is the input. Recurring is the keyword; one-offs just get done.
- 2 **Ask the two questions per item.** Structurable? Someone's primary? The answers pick the path.
- 3 **Attach a named tool to each.** Triage without a tool is a diagnosis without a prescription.
- 4 **Re-triage quarterly.** Teams change, tools improve, trades open up. The tree is a habit, not a one-time sort.

The four paths

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| 1 Scaffold it | Recurring and structurable: build the template or checklist once, run it forever. Tools 1-8, 11-19, 21-29. |
| 2 Timebox it | Small, unavoidable, unstructurable: contain it to scheduled peak-energy doses. Tools 5 and 31. |
| 3 Trade it | Draining for you, energizing for a colleague: the framework's favorite move. Tools 10, 20, 33. |
| 4 Automate it | Repeatable and rule-based: hand it to software or AI entirely. Tool 9 and its cousins. |

WHAT IT WON'T DO

Triage manages the drain; a fraction of tertiary work always remains that must simply be done, and the honest frame is that it will cost energy and that is acceptable in bounded doses. What is not acceptable is unbounded, unmanaged, undiscussed drain, which is what the tree exists to end.

IN THE KIT

Decision tree card

Recurring-drain inventory

Path-to-tool map

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 31 Energy Budget Planner · **Tool 33** Team Trade Board · **Tool 9** AI Precision Companion